



AFTER

The slaughter at Fredericksburg was greeted with jubilation in the South and consternation in Washington. Lincoln was criticized and anti-war sentiment flourished in Union ranks.

BURNSIDE'S HOPES DASHED

Ambrose Burnside dreamed of redeeming his reputation with **another crossing of the Rappahannock River** that would outflank Lee. However, attempting this maneuver in January 1863 his army became bogged down on muddy roads. **After this "Mud March"** was called off, **Burnside was doomed**. On January 26, he was replaced by Major General "Fightin' Joe" Hooker.

FLEEING ENSLAVEMENT

Confederate and Union troops occupied Fredericksburg in turn through 1862. When Union troops were present, thousands of enslaved people escaped; **many would work for the Union or later enlist (see [The Role of Black Troops](#))**. John Washington did both, recalling how "day after day the slaves came into the camp and every where that the 'Stars and Stripes' waved they seemed to know freedom had dawned."



CLAIMING
FREEDOM